



FSAT

FGM/C Self-Assessment Tool

User Guide

Step-by-Step Instructions for Clinical and Personal Use

INTRODUCTION

This guide explains how to use FSAT in both clinical and educational settings. The tool is designed to support communication, education, screening, and data collection during outpatient consultations and raise awareness, while improving information access, care, and documentation. It may also be used for prevalence studies.

It features watercolor illustrations by *Florine Guenat*, based on selected photographs from:



Abdulcadir J, Sachs Guedj N, Yaron M, editors. Female Genital Mutilation/Cutting in Children and Adolescents: Illustrated Guide to Diagnose, Assess, Inform and Report. Cham (CH): Springer; 2022.

The watercolors were evaluated in a study comparing women's self-assessment of their FGM/C type with the WHO classification identified through specialist examination.



Hunziker L, Locher S, Abdulcadir J. Concordance between self-assessment using watercolor illustrations and clinical examination: implementing a visual tool to improve recognition and communication on female genital mutilation/cutting. J Sex Med. 2026 Jun 5;23(7):qdag190. doi: 10.1093/jsxmed/qdag190

ACCESS THE TOOL

Users can begin by opening the FSAT web application:

 <https://fsat-app.github.io>

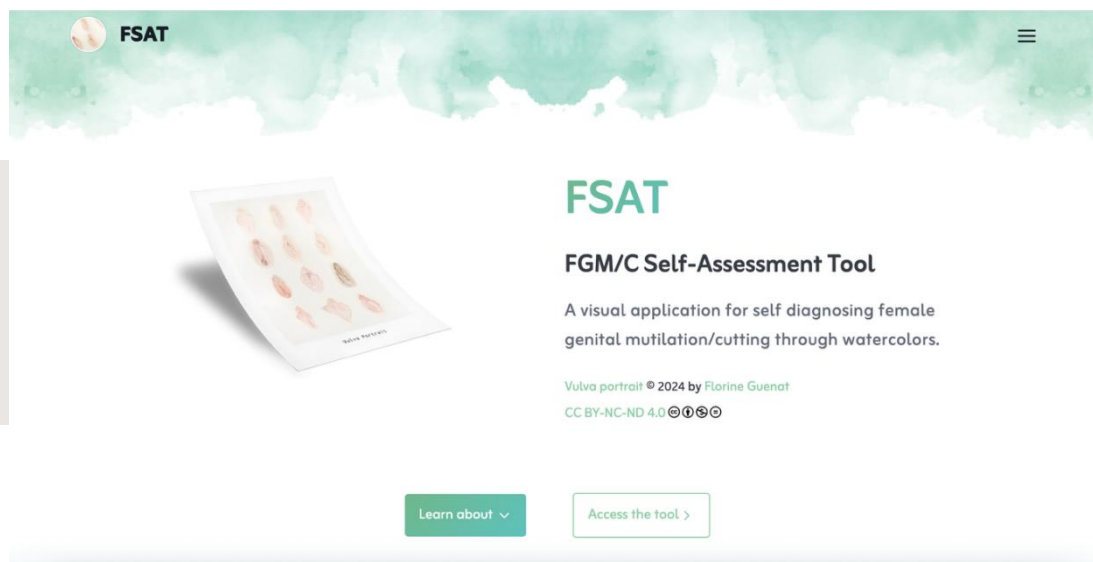
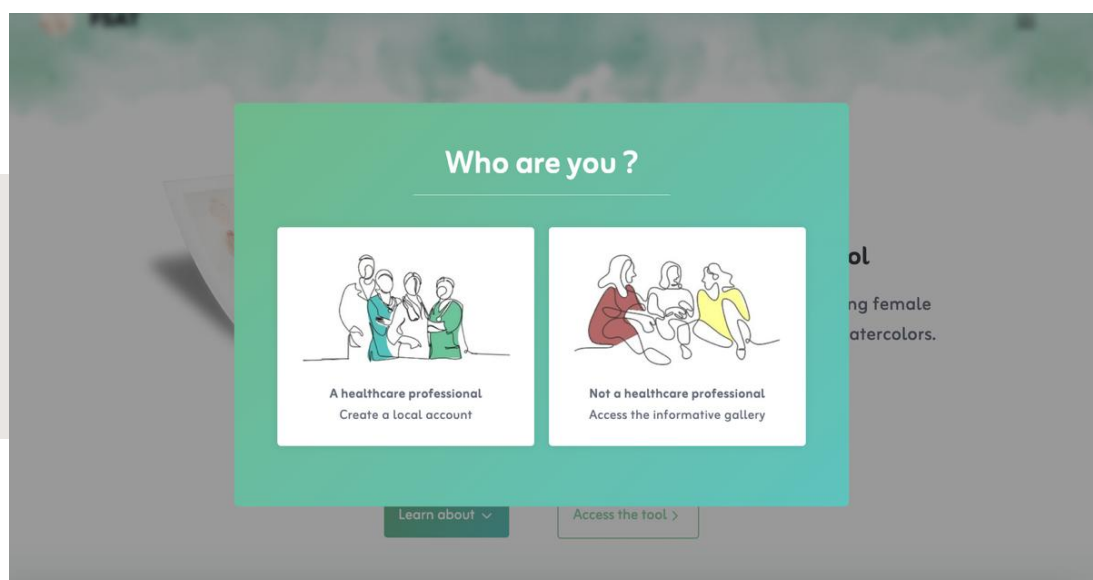


Figure 1 - Homepage

From the homepage, click on ***Access the tool***. This will open the main access page where users must choose between two pathways:



This step ensures that users are directed to the section most appropriate for their needs.

FOR HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONALS

Step 1 – Create a Local Account

Healthcare professionals should first create a **local account**. This account is stored only **in the current web browser** and is accessible only on the current device. No data is sent online.

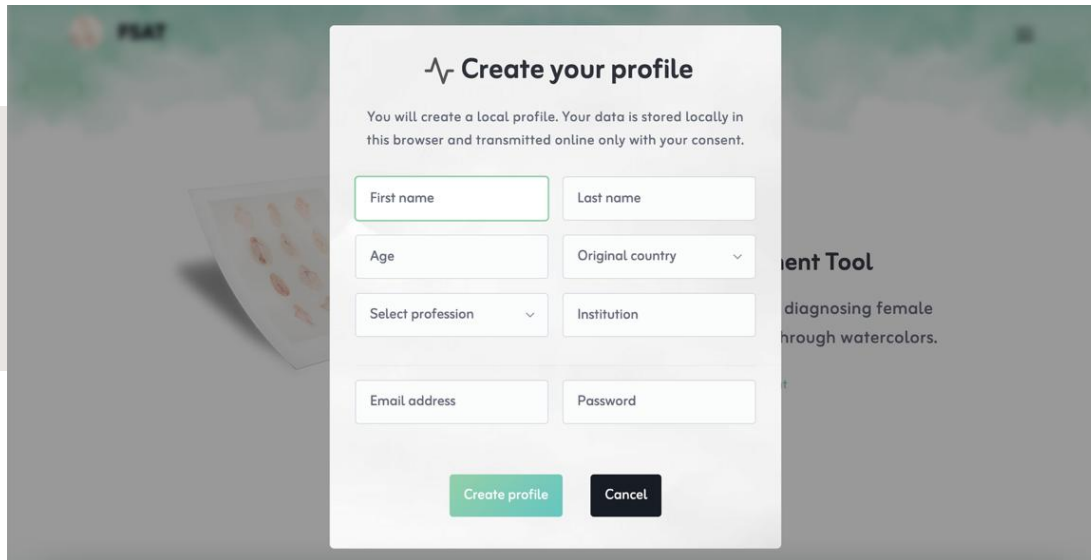
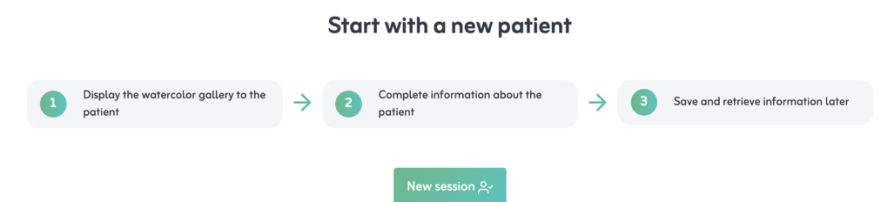


Figure 2 - Create account page

This local account enables secure and confidential use of the tool. It can also be used **in environments with limited or no internet access**.

Step 2 – Start a New Session

This tool is designed to be used during healthcare consultations to support communication with patients. Click **“New Session.”**



At this point, the healthcare professional hands the device (computer, tablet, or smartphone) to the patient.

The patient is invited to look at the **image gallery** and select the image that best resembles her anatomy.

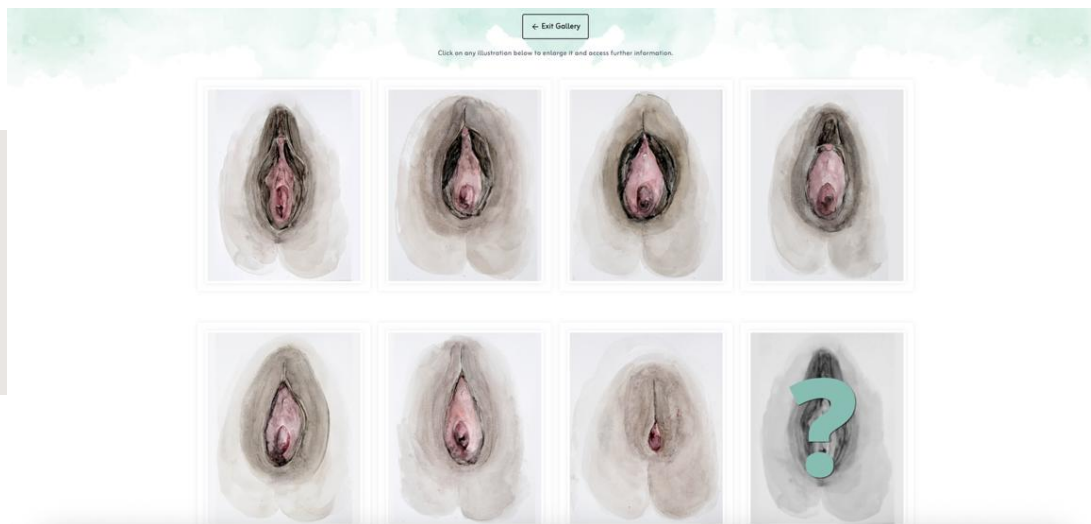


Figure 3 - Image gallery

Once the image has been selected, the device is handed back to the healthcare professional.

Step 3 – Complete Patient Information

The healthcare professional can complete the patient information section. Please **complete all relevant patient information** after the image selection.

Figure 4 - Patient information page

Step 4 – Explore Your Data

After the consultation, click **“Explore Your Data.”**

This section provides a visual overview of the data collected through the application.

Healthcare professionals can explore **graphs and summary diagrams** based on patient data, such as **FGM/C types, countries of origin, current ages, and age at FGM/C.**

This feature is particularly useful for obtaining an overall view of the patient population and possibly monitoring incidence and prevalence of FGM/C.

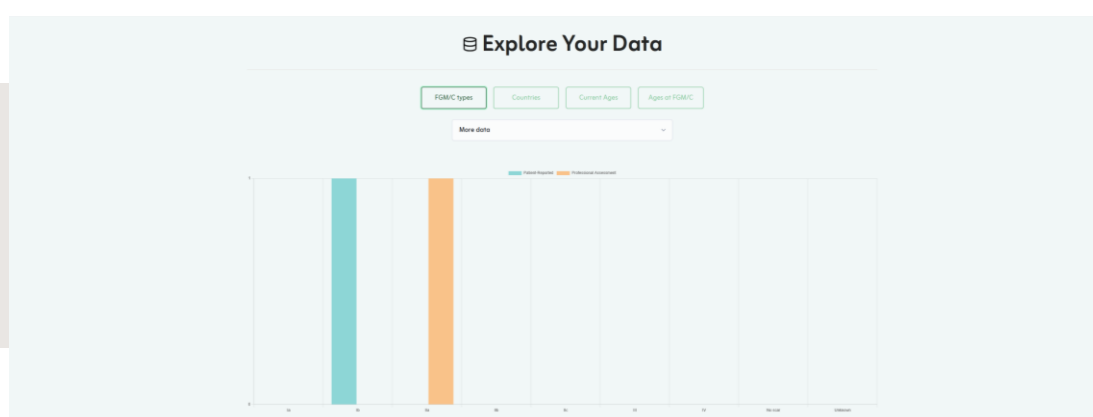


Figure 5 - Explore your data dashboard

Step 5 – Access and Export Stored Patient Data

Below the data visualization dashboard, healthcare professionals can access the **list of patients registered on the local device.**

This section allows users to view previously recorded patient sessions stored directly on the device.

Patient information remains accessible through the application, including in settings with limited or no internet connection.

The data can also be exported in **.csv** or **.xlsx** format for clinical follow-up, documentation, or research purposes.

All exported data are **pseudonymized** to help protect patient confidentiality.

Step 6 – Contribute to Research

The tool also allows users to contribute to ongoing research.

By clicking “**Synchronize**,” data can be securely shared with the research team of the FGM/C [outpatient clinic of Geneva University Hospitals](https://www.hug.ch/en/gynecologie/female-genital-mutilation)¹ in agreement with eventual previous ethical commission approvals.

All transmitted data are anonymized, and only records for which explicit consent has been provided will be shared.

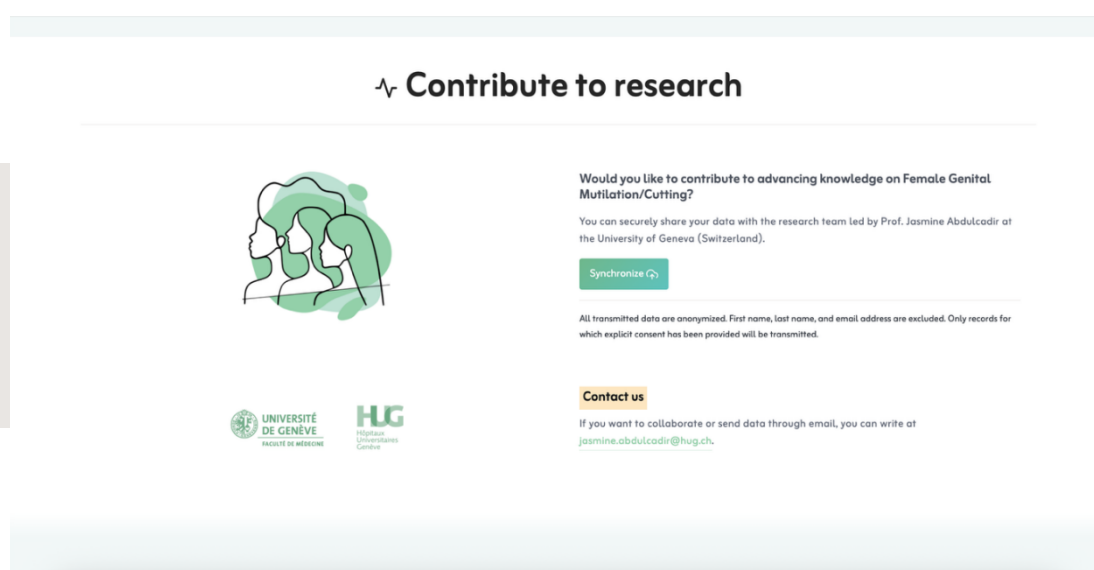


Figure 6 - Synchronize button

¹ <https://www.hug.ch/en/gynecologie/female-genital-mutilation>

EDUCATIONAL USE FOR THE GENERAL PUBLIC

Educational Use

From the **“Access the tool”** page, click on **“Not a Healthcare Professional.”**

The application can then be used outside of a healthcare consultation.

This section is designed for anyone who wishes to learn more about genital anatomy and the different types of FGM/C.

Users can access the **illustration gallery**, browse the watercolor images, and click on each illustration to enlarge it and obtain further information.

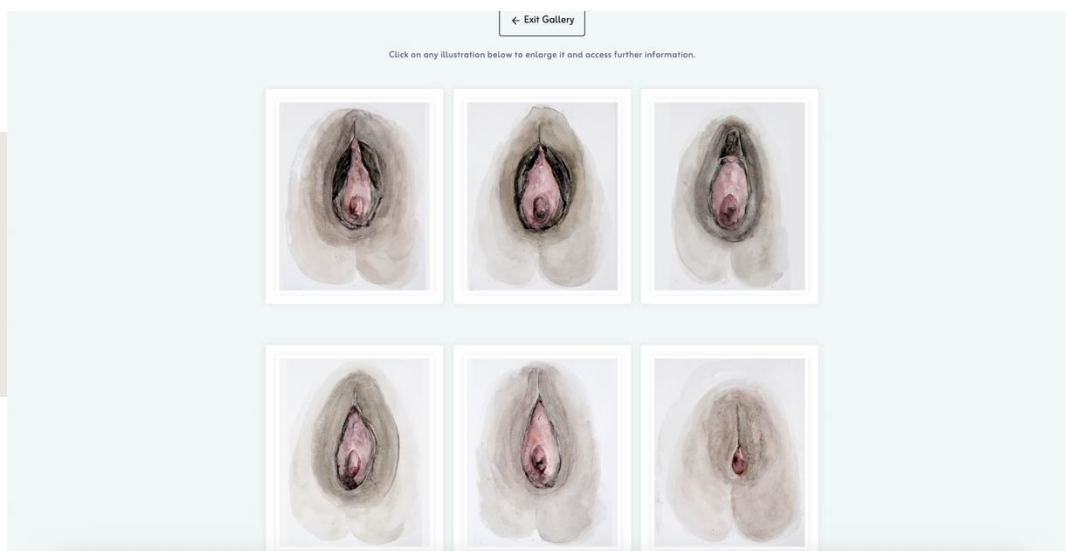


Figure 7 - Illustration gallery

For each illustration, the corresponding **WHO explanatory diagram** is displayed alongside the watercolor image.

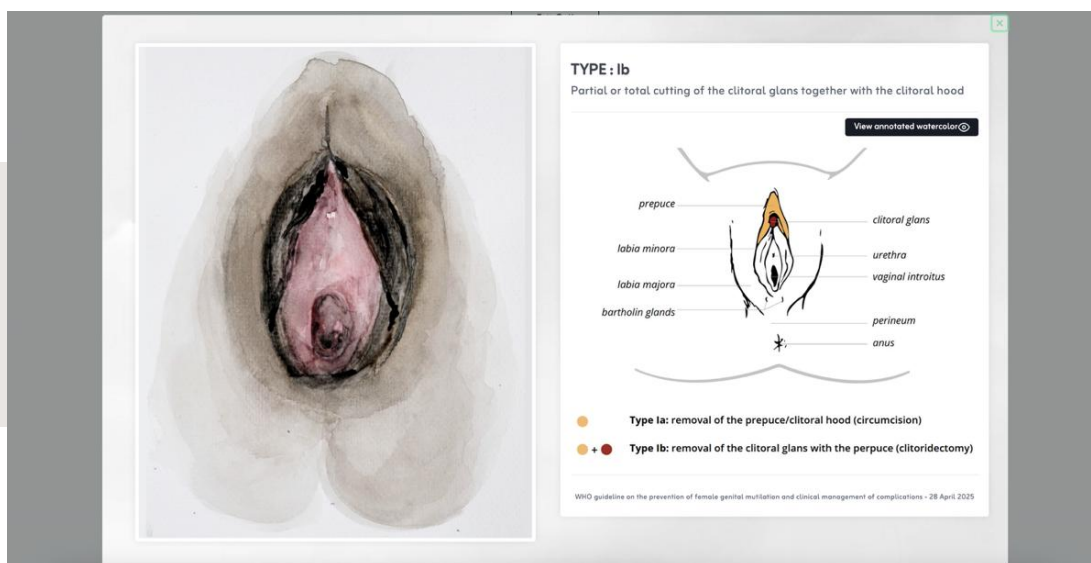


Figure 8 - Watercolor illustration and WHO reference diagram

Users can then click to view an **annotated watercolor version**, allowing a direct comparison between the artistic representation and the labeled anatomical structures.

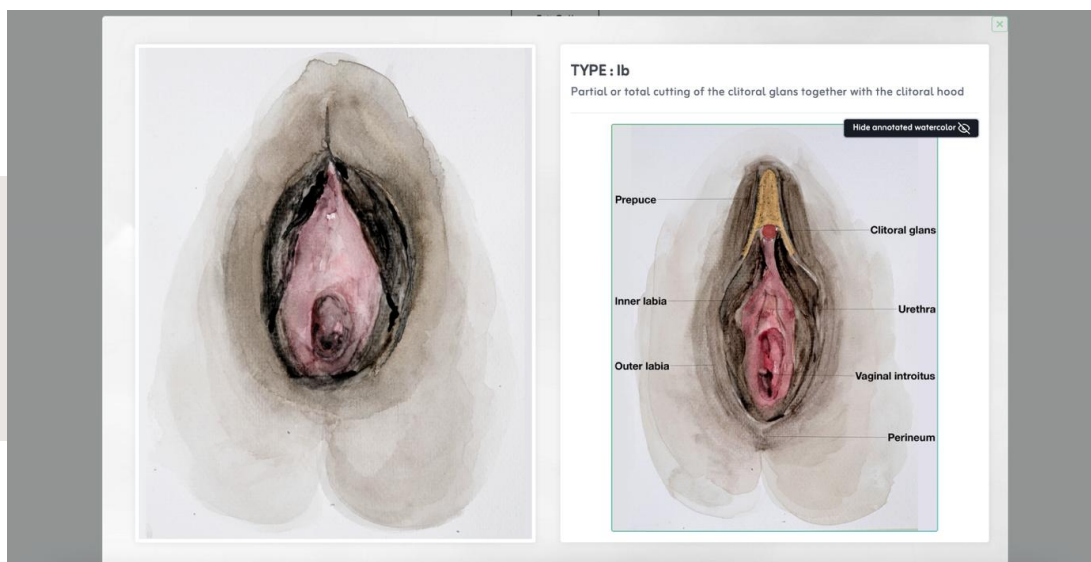


Figure 9 - Watercolor illustration and annotated watercolor

KEY FEATURES

- **Secure local data storage**

Patient data are stored directly on the device.

- **Offline accessibility**

The tool remains functional in settings with limited or no internet connection.

- **Patient-centered visual communication**

Watercolor illustrations facilitate communication during consultations.

- **WHO-based educational diagrams**

Users can compare illustrations with WHO reference diagrams and annotated views.

- **Pseudonymized data export**

Data can be exported in **.csv** and **.xlsx** formats.

- **Research contribution**

Data can be securely synchronized with the research team upon consent.

CREDITS

This tool was co-developed by Laleh Hunziker, Sophie Locher, Julien Da Costa and Jasmine Abdulcadir from [Geneva University hospitals](#) and [University of Geneva](#).

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